

Technology News

Robotic pant for the paralysed

After an accident left Israeli entrepreneur Amit Goffer paralysed in 1997, he decided to develop a system that offers an ambulation alternative to wheelchair users. The result was 'ReWalk.' The device, worn outside of clothing, not only enables paralysed people to stand and walk but also climb stairs. The novelty of

ReWalk is the manner in which the user is actively involved in walk restoration and other mobility functions through the control processes. After years of clinical testing in the US and Israel, the device will now go on sale to rehabilitation centres worldwide.

ReWalk consists of leg braces outfitted with motion sensors and motorised joints that are triggered by

upper-body movement. A harness around the patient's waist and shoulders keeps the suit in place; it also includes a backpack with a computer and rechargeable battery.

Robot interacting with fans online

Pop artist Talay Riley has found a unique way to interact with his fans—a robotic arm installation that writes Twitter and Facebook messages. "Send me a message and see me write it," Talay Robot describes himself in his bio on Twitter.

The installation at the reception of Sony Music London consists of an industrial robotic arm which is connected to the Internet and programmed to write messages that it receives from Twitter and Facebook.

The robot films each message and posts back to the sender (and any friend he mentions) a video of his message being written—soundtracked to Talay's new single Sergeant Smash.

Tweet the robot to @talayrobot in order to see one of the coolest intersections of robotics and social networking.

World's smallest battery

Researchers at the Center for Integrated Nanotechnologies (CINT) claim to have created the tiniest battery in the world. The rechargeable, lithium-based battery was developed by a team led by researcher Jianyu Huang.

The battery comprises a 3mm long lithium cobalt cathode, a single tin-oxide nanowire anode and an ionic liquid electrolyte. The anode, which measures 10 nanometres (nm) in length and 100 nm in diameter, is one seven-thousandth the thickness of a human hair.

A lithium-ion battery with nanowire-based materials greatly increases the power and energy density com-



The ReWalk from ARGO Medical Technologies—a company founded by Dr Amit Goffer